

THE BEGINNER'S GUIDE

Your First Digital Product

A step-by-step guide to creating, launching and selling on Gumroad — even with no audience.

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Sell & grow

Waslerr

10 chapters · 30-day plan · 3 worksheets

Your First Digital Product

A step-by-step guide to creating, launching and selling on Gumroad

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Start here

You already know something that other people would pay to learn faster. This guide shows you how to package it.

Why digital products?

A digital product is anything people can buy and download or access online: an e-book, a template, a set of photo presets, a spreadsheet, a short video course, a design kit. Once it exists, you can sell it again and again without making it again.

- **You create it once.** The work happens up front. After that, each sale costs you almost nothing.
- **You need very little money to start.** No stock, no shipping, no warehouse. A laptop and free tools are enough.
- **It works while you sleep.** A platform like Gumroad handles payment and delivery automatically, at any hour, in any country.
- **It teaches you business.** Even a small product teaches you how to find customers, write a sales page and price your work — skills you keep forever.

AN HONEST NOTE

Digital products are not a get-rich-quick trick. Many first products make only a few sales, and that is normal. The goal of your first product is to **finish, publish and learn**. Your second and third products are where things usually start to grow, because you build on what you learned.

Why Gumroad?

Gumroad is made for independent creators. You upload a file, write a page, set a price and share a link. Gumroad handles checkout, payment, file delivery, receipts and customer emails. You don't need your own website, and instead of a monthly fee it charges a fee on each sale (check its pricing page for current rates).

How to use this guide

- 1 **Read one chapter at a time.** Each chapter covers one step, in the order you'll need it.
- 2 **Do the action step at the end of each chapter.** Reading without doing will not create a product. The action steps will.
- 3 **Use the worksheets and the 30-day plan.** Print the worksheets or copy them into a notebook. Chapter 10 turns everything into a daily checklist, from idea to launch in one month.

ACTION STEP

Open your calendar and block **45 minutes a day for the next 30 days**. Name it "My product". This is the single most important step in this book.

Find your idea

The best first product solves a specific problem for a specific person — and you already have the answer.

Most people get stuck here because they look for a "great" idea. You don't need a great idea. You need a **useful** one: something that saves someone time, money, stress or confusion.

Three places to find ideas

1. What you know

Skills from your job, studies or hobbies. Design, cooking, Excel, a language, fitness, photography, coding, studying for exams, organizing an event. Things that feel "obvious" to you are often hard for beginners.

2. What you've done

Problems you have already solved for yourself. Did you learn to code alone? Build a morning routine? Find a job abroad? Pay off a debt? Grow a social account? Your journey is a map someone else wants to follow.

3. What people ask you

If friends, colleagues or followers regularly ask you the same question, that question is a product. "How did you make that website?" "Can you share your budget sheet?" "Which camera settings do you use?"

Make it specific

"A guide to fitness" is hard to sell because it's for everyone, which means it's for no one. "A 20-minute home workout plan for busy parents" is easy to sell because the right person immediately thinks: *that's for me*.

I help **[who]** get **[result]** without **[pain]**.

EXAMPLES

- I help **freelance designers** track clients and invoices **without messy spreadsheets**. → *Notion client tracker template*
- I help **food bloggers** get bright, consistent photos **without hours of editing**. → *Lightroom preset pack*
- I help **beginner developers** build a portfolio site **without starting from zero**. → *HTML/CSS website template*
- I help **students** prepare for an exam **without feeling lost**. → *Study guide + revision checklist*

The good-idea filter

Score each idea from 1 to 5 on these questions. Pick the one with the highest total.

Question	Why it matters
Can I make a first version in 2 weeks or less?	Your first product should be small. Finishing beats perfecting.
Do I know more about this than a beginner?	You don't need to be an expert — just a few steps ahead of your buyer.
Is the problem painful or valuable?	People pay to save time, make money, look good or reduce stress.
Can I name where these people hang out online?	If you can't find them, you can't sell to them.
Do I enjoy this topic?	You'll talk about it a lot while marketing. Enjoyment keeps you going.

ACTION STEP

Fill in the **Idea Finder worksheet** at the end of this book. Write at least 10 ideas, score them, and circle your top one.

CHAPTER 02

Choose your format

The same knowledge can become many kinds of products. Pick the format that's quickest for you to make and easiest for your buyer to use.

Format	Good for	Effort	Tools you can use
Checklist / cheat sheet	Quick wins, steps people forget	Low	Canva, Google Docs
E-book / PDF guide	Explaining a process from start to finish	Medium	Google Docs, Canva, Word
Template	Saving people setup time	Low–medium	Notion, Google Sheets, Canva, Figma
Design assets	Icons, fonts, mockups, UI kits, presets	Medium	Figma, Illustrator, Lightroom
Code	Website templates, scripts, plugins	Medium–high	Your code editor
Video course	Skills people need to see	High	Screen recorder, phone camera
Membership	Ongoing content, community, updates	Ongoing	Gumroad memberships

Start small, then grow

For a first product, choose a format you can finish in **one to two weeks**. A focused 25-page guide or a single excellent template is better than a 10-hour course you never finish.

You can always turn a small product into a bigger one later. A checklist can grow into a guide. A guide can grow into a course. Each version teaches you what buyers actually want.

TIP: COMBINE FORMATS

A guide plus a template or checklist feels more valuable than either one alone, and it helps buyers take action. For example: "The guide explains *why*, the template does the work for you."

ACTION STEP

Write down your chosen format and a **one-sentence description** of your product using the formula from Chapter 1.

Validate before you build

Spend a few days checking that people want your idea before you spend weeks building it.

Look for demand signals

- **Questions online.** Search Reddit, Facebook groups, Discord servers, forums, Google and YouTube for your topic. Are people asking for help with this problem?
- **Similar products already selling.** Search Gumroad Discover, Etsy and other marketplaces. Competition is a *good* sign — it proves people pay for this. Read their reviews to see what buyers love and what's missing.

FIND YOUR ANGLE

When you find similar products, don't copy them. Look for the gap: a more specific audience, a simpler explanation, a different language, a better design, or a more practical format. "The same thing, but for *this specific person*" is a strong position.

Ask real people

Talk to 5–10 people who match your target buyer. Don't ask "Would you buy this?" — people say yes to be polite. Ask about their experience: *"What's the hardest part of [problem] for you? What have you already tried? Have you ever paid for help with this?"*

Write down the exact words they use. You'll reuse them on your product page — buyers respond to their own language.

Build a waitlist with a free product

Create a **free product** on Gumroad (price 0) called something like "Join the waitlist — [Your Product]". Describe what's coming and share the link. Everyone who gets it gives you their email, so you can contact them when you launch.

THE 10-PERSON TEST

If **10 people** join your waitlist, ask about it, or say "tell me when it's ready", you have enough signal to start building. If not, try a more specific audience or a different angle first.

ACTION STEP

Find **3 places** online where your buyers ask questions, and **3 similar products**. Write down what buyers praise and complain about in their reviews.

Create your product

Your goal is not the perfect product. It's the smallest product that gets your buyer a real result.

Start with the result, then work backwards

Write one sentence: "After using this, my buyer will be able to ____." Every page, template or video in your product should help with that sentence. If it doesn't, cut it or save it for a future product.

Outline first

- 1 **List every step** your buyer must take to reach the result.
- 2 **Group the steps** into 5–10 sections or chapters.
- 3 **Under each section**, write 3–5 bullet points of what to cover.
- 4 **Add one practical element** per section: an example, a checklist, a template or an exercise.

With a good outline, writing becomes "fill in the blanks" instead of staring at an empty page. Set a deadline, work in short focused blocks, and **write first, edit later** — editing while you write is the slowest way to make anything.

A SIMPLE STRUCTURE FOR GUIDES

Promise (what they'll achieve) → **Steps** (the process, in order) → **Examples** (what "good" looks like) → **Action** (something to do right now).

Quality checklist before you publish

- ☐ Proofread everything. Read it out loud — you'll catch mistakes your eyes skip. A free grammar checker helps too.
- ☐ Test every link, button and template copy.
- ☐ Open the file on a phone. Many buyers will read it there first.
- ☐ Name files clearly (Product-Name-Guide.pdf, not final_v3_REAL.pdf). If there are several files, add a "Start here" PDF.
- ☐ Ask one person from your target audience to try it and tell you where they got confused.

Avoid "just one more thing". Endless bonuses and extra chapters are a way of avoiding launch. If the core product solves the problem, it's ready. Save extra ideas for an update or your next product.

ACTION STEP

Write your **result sentence** and your **outline**. Then set a finish date no more than 14 days from today.

Set your price

People don't pay for pages or hours. They pay for the result and the time they save.

Price on value

Ask: "What is this result worth to my buyer?" A template that saves a freelancer five hours of admin every month is worth more than a template that's simply nice to look at — even if both took you the same time to make.

Use the market as your guide

Look at the similar products you found in Chapter 3: their prices, what's included, and how many ratings they have. As a beginner with no reviews yet, the lower-middle of that range is usually a safe start. You can raise your price as you add reviews and improvements.

Don't underprice out of fear. A very low price can make a product look low-value, and you need many more sales to earn the same amount.

Pricing options on Gumroad

Option	How it works	When to use it
Fixed price	One price for everyone	Most products
Pay what you want	Set a minimum (it can be 0); buyers can pay more	Building an audience, testing demand
Versions	Several tiers on one page, e.g. Basic (the guide) and Pro (guide + templates)	When you can offer more for more
Discount codes	A code that lowers the price	Launches, waitlist members, partners
Free	Price of 0	Lead magnets and waitlists to collect emails

Remember the fees. Gumroad takes a fee on each sale, and a higher one on sales that come through its Discover marketplace. Check the current rates on Gumroad's pricing page so you know what you actually earn.

ACTION STEP

Write down the prices of 3 similar products, choose your launch price, and decide whether you'll offer versions.

Build a product page that sells

Your product page does the selling for you, 24 hours a day. Make it clear, specific and easy to trust.

1. The name

Clear beats clever. A buyer should understand what it is and who it's for in two seconds.

[Result] + [Format] for [Who]

For example: "Client Tracker Notion Template for Freelance Designers" or "Bright & Airy Lightroom Presets for Food Bloggers".

2. The cover and thumbnail

- **Cover:** the big image at the top of your page. A wide image (Gumroad suggests at least 1280 × 720 pixels) works well. You can add several cover images or a video to show the inside.
- **Thumbnail:** the small square image shown in your store and in Discover (Gumroad recommends at least 600 × 600 pixels). Keep text big and short — it's often seen at a tiny size.
- **Show the product.** Mockups, screenshots of real pages, or a preview of the template are more convincing than an abstract design.

3. The description

Follow this structure, top to bottom:

- 1 **Hook:** name the problem or the result in one or two lines.
- 2 **Who it's for** (and who it's not for). This builds trust.
- 3 **What's inside:** a bullet list of everything included.
- 4 **What you'll be able to do:** the results, in your buyer's words.
- 5 **Previews:** images of real pages or screens.
- 6 **About you:** one short paragraph on why you can help.
- 7 **FAQ:** format, file type, updates, refunds, how to access.

A description template you can copy

Tired of [problem]? [Product name] helps you [result] — without [pain].

This is for you if:

- ✓ You are [type of person]
- ✓ You want to [goal]
- ✓ You've tried [common solution] and it didn't work

What's inside:

- [Item 1] — [what it helps with]
- [Item 2] — [what it helps with]
- [Item 3] — [what it helps with]

After using it, you will be able to:

- [Result 1]
- [Result 2]

Why me? [One or two sentences about your experience.]

FAQ

Format? [PDF, X pages / Notion template / ZIP file]

Updates? [Yes, free updates for buyers]

Refunds? [Your policy]

4. Settings that matter

- ☐ **Custom URL:** set a short, readable link for your product (e.g. /l/first-product).
- ☐ **Summary:** add the short "You'll get..." line with the format and size (e.g. "45-page PDF + 3 templates").
- ☐ **Call-to-action button:** choose button text that fits your product, such as "I want this!" or "Buy this".
- ☐ **Category and tags:** fill them in carefully — they help people find you in Discover.
- ☐ **Receipt message:** thank the buyer and tell them exactly how to start.
- ☐ **Refund policy:** state it clearly. A clear policy increases trust.
- ☐ **Test it:** preview the page on a phone and do a test checkout (for example with a 100% discount code) to check delivery.

ACTION STEP

Use the **Product Page Builder worksheet** to draft your name, summary and description. Then create your product on Gumroad as a draft.

Launch it

A launch is not one post. It's a short, planned period where you give your product your full attention.

Phase 1 — Pre-launch (7 days before)

- Tell people what you're making and why. Share the problem it solves.
- Share your progress: a screenshot, a page preview, a "before and after".
- Invite people to your free waitlist (Chapter 3).
- Prepare all your launch posts and emails in advance, so launch day is calm.

Phase 2 — Launch day

- Publish the product and test the checkout one final time.
- Email your waitlist first, with a **launch discount code** that has a clear end date.
- Post on every channel where your audience is.
- Send personal messages to people who helped or showed interest. Personal messages often work better than public posts.
- Be online to answer questions quickly.

Phase 3 — Launch week

- Share a different angle each day: a tip from the product, a preview, a question you received, why you made it.
- Remind people before the discount ends. Many people buy on the last day.
- Thank your first buyers and ask for their feedback.

Launch email example

Subject: It's live — [Product name]

Hi [name],

You joined the waitlist for [Product name], and today it's live.

It helps you [result] without [pain]. Inside you'll find:

- [Item 1]
- [Item 2]
- [Item 3]

As a thank-you for waiting, use code [CODE] for [X]% off until [date].

→ [Link]

Reply to this email if you have any questions — I read every reply.

[Your name]

After the launch

Sales usually spike during launch and then slow down. That's normal. Now your job is to keep bringing people to the page (Chapter 8) and to improve the product using feedback. Gumroad lets you email your customers, so you can share updates and ask for ratings.

ACTION STEP

Pick your launch date. Write your **launch email and 7 posts** (one for each day of launch week) before that date.

Market without a big audience

You don't need thousands of followers. You need to be helpful in the places your buyers already are.

Be helpful where your buyers are

Go back to the communities you found in Chapter 3. Answer questions properly and generously. When it's relevant *and allowed by the community rules*, mention your product as one option. Never spam links — it damages your reputation and can get you banned.

Create content that teaches

A simple rule: **teach most of the time, sell some of the time**. Each piece of your product can become content:

- One tip from the guide → a short post or video
- One checklist → a carousel or thread
- One mistake beginners make → a story post
- One buyer question → a helpful answer, posted publicly

Choose **one or two platforms** and post consistently, rather than posting rarely on many.

Build an email list from day one

Social media reach changes all the time; an email list is yours. Offer a small free product — a checklist, a mini-guide, a sample template — on Gumroad. Everyone who downloads it becomes a contact you can tell about future products.

Use search: content that keeps working

Posts on social feeds disappear in a day. Content on **YouTube, Pinterest or a blog** can be found through search for months or years. One good tutorial that answers a common question can bring visitors to your product long after you publish it.

Work with others

- **Collaborations:** partner with a creator whose audience overlaps with yours — a guest post, a joint live session, or a bundle.
- **Affiliates:** Gumroad lets you add affiliates who earn a percentage of each sale they bring you.
- **Discover:** Gumroad's marketplace can show your product to new buyers. Good tags, a clear thumbnail and positive ratings help.

Measure what works

Gumroad's analytics show your views and sales. Watch two numbers:

Number	What it tells you	If it's low...
Views	How many people see your page	Market more, in more relevant places
Conversion (sales ÷ views)	How convincing your page is	Improve title, cover, description, price

Use separate links or discount codes for each channel so you can see where your buyers come from. Then do more of what works.

ACTION STEP

Choose your **main platform**, plan **10 posts** based on content from your product, and create your **free lead magnet**.

Grow from one product to a store

Your first product is the beginning. The real opportunity is a small set of products that serve the same people.

Improve what you have

Read every message and review. If several buyers get confused at the same point, fix it and send an update to all your customers. Updates show you care, and they're a natural reason to contact buyers again.

Build a product ladder

Offer products at different levels so people can start small and go further with you:

Level	Example	Purpose
Free	Checklist or sample	Builds your email list and trust
Starter	Guide or single template	First purchase, low risk for the buyer
Core	Complete toolkit or bundle	Your main product
Premium	Course, coaching or membership	For buyers who want the most help

Sell more to happy buyers

- **Bundles:** group related products at a better total price.
- **Upsells:** suggest a related product or a higher version at checkout.
- **Follow-up emails:** send helpful tips after purchase, then mention your next product.

Make your second product

The easiest second product answers this question: *"What does my buyer need next?"* Look at the questions your buyers ask after they use your first product. That's your next idea, already validated.

CONSISTENCY WINS

Most successful creators didn't have one big hit. They kept publishing, improving and showing up for the same audience for months. Every product makes the next one easier to sell.

ACTION STEP

Draw your product ladder. Write one idea for each level, and pick your next product.

CHAPTER 10

Your 30-day action plan

45 minutes a day. Four weeks. One published product.

Week 1 — Idea & validation

- ☐ Day 1–2: Complete the Idea Finder worksheet. Pick your top idea.
- ☐ Day 3: Write your "I help [who] get [result] without [pain]" sentence. Choose a format.
- ☐ Day 4: Find 3 communities and 3 similar products. Note reviews and prices.
- ☐ Day 5–6: Talk to 5 people from your audience. Save their exact words.
- ☐ Day 7: Create your free waitlist product on Gumroad and share it.

Week 2 — Create

- ☐ Day 8: Write your result sentence and full outline.
- ☐ Day 9–12: Create the core content. Write first, edit later.
- ☐ Day 13: Design and format. Export the final files.
- ☐ Day 14: Run the quality checklist. Ask one person to test it.

Week 3 — Product page & pre-launch

- ☐ Day 15: Set your price and versions.
- ☐ Day 16: Create the cover, thumbnail and preview images.
- ☐ Day 17: Write the product page using the template. Set up all settings.
- ☐ Day 18: Do a test purchase. Fix anything that's unclear.
- ☐ Day 19–21: Share your progress, invite people to the waitlist, write launch posts and email.

Week 4 — Launch & learn

- ☐ Day 22: Launch! Email the waitlist with a launch code. Post everywhere. Send personal messages.
- ☐ Day 23–27: Post a new angle every day. Answer every question.
- ☐ Day 28: Last day of the launch discount — send a reminder.
- ☐ Day 29: Thank buyers and ask for feedback and ratings.
- ☐ Day 30: Review your numbers. Write down 3 lessons and your next product idea.

WORKSHEET 1

Idea Finder

Write fast. Don't judge your ideas yet.

Skills I have (from work, study, hobbies)

Problems I have solved for myself

Questions people often ask me

Score your top 3 ideas (1–5 each)

Idea	Fast to make	I know it	Painful problem	Can find buyers	I enjoy it	Total

My product in one sentence

I help [who] get [result] without [pain].

WORKSHEET 2

Product Page Builder

Draft your page here, then copy it into Gumroad.

Product name

[Result] + [Format] for [Who]

Summary ("You'll get...")

Format and size, e.g. "30-page PDF + 2 templates"

Hook (first 2 lines of the description)

This is for you if...

What's inside

Price & versions

Tags & category

WORKSHEET 3

Launch Checklist

Tick every box before and during launch.

Product

- ☐ Proofread and tested on desktop and phone
- ☐ Files named clearly; "Start here" included if there are several files
- ☐ Tested by at least one person from my audience

Product page

- ☐ Clear name, summary and description
- ☐ Cover image(s) and square thumbnail added
- ☐ Price, versions and discount code set up
- ☐ Custom URL, category, tags and receipt message set
- ☐ Refund policy written
- ☐ Test purchase completed and file delivered correctly

Marketing

- ☐ Waitlist invited and launch email written
- ☐ 7 launch-week posts written
- ☐ List of people to message personally
- ☐ Free lead magnet published

After launch

- ☐ First buyers thanked and asked for feedback
- ☐ Views and conversion checked
- ☐ 3 lessons written down
- ☐ Next product idea chosen

Now, go make it.

You have everything you need: a way to find your idea, a process to build it, and a plan to launch it.

Your first product doesn't have to be perfect. It has to be **published**. Every creator you admire started with a first product that was smaller and simpler than what they make today.

Thank you for reading — and good luck with your launch.

— Waslerr

Find more resources at waslerr.gumroad.com